

323 Put together a naturalist's kit

30
MINS

A naturalist is someone who not only looks carefully at the natural world, but also records those observations and learns from them. You can put together a kit and make your own discoveries!



What you need

• Backpack • Notebook
• Pencils • Insect net
• Magnifying glass
• Binoculars • Tape measure • Penknife

1 Use a light backpack for essentials. Find one with outside pockets so you can carry things like water bottles (for you) and collecting bags (for your specimens).

2 Binoculars will help you see far-away creatures such as birds or squirrels, while a magnifying glass takes you into the tiny world of insects.

3 Pack a notebook and pen to write down or draw your observations. A small ruler or tape measure is handy, too, as is a small insect net. Don't forget to use your own senses—they're the most important tools of all.



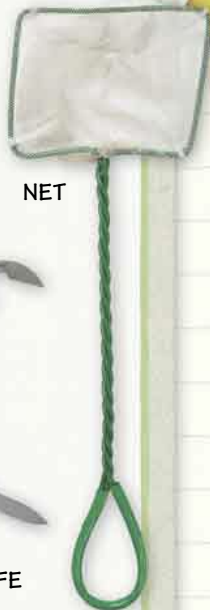
NOTEBOOKS



MAGNIFYING GLASS



PENKNIFE



NET



TAPE MEASURE



BINOCULARS

324 Follow a snail trail

5
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It's easy to find a snail—just look for a silvery, shiny trail of slime on the surface of a leaf, the sidewalk, or a plant pot. See if you can trace it to the snail itself.

Slimy snail trail